

## Technical Considerations of Firefox Mobile OS

|                              |                                                    |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| OS name                      | Firefox OS                                         |
| Initial name                 | Geekphone, 'Boot to Gecko/B2G' Project             |
| OS type                      | Mobile OS                                          |
| Company                      | Mozilla Corporation                                |
| Developer                    | Mozilla Corporation                                |
| Developed in                 | C++, HTML5, CSS, JavaScript                        |
| Source model                 | Open source                                        |
| Supported platforms          | ARM and x86                                        |
| Kernel                       | Linux                                              |
| Firefox OS Simulator version | 1.0, 2.0, 3.0                                      |
| OS features                  | Almost similar to Android, iPhone, Windows 8 Phone |
| Price                        | Free                                               |



Fig. 4: The ZTE phone with Firefox OS loaded



Fig. 5: Features of Firefox OS

mobile phones; so why would anyone switch to Firefox OS? With Firefox OS, Mozilla is in a race to improve its software, and attract developers and partners before its rivals move

into the low-end smartphone market.

## Comparisons with other mobile operating systems

Firefox OS has been developed with the combination of C++, HTML5, CSS and JavaScript. It is based entirely on open standards, and there's no proprietary software or technology involved. HTML5 is known to many developers and it would be an easy way to develop apps for Firefox OS-enabled phones. As with Apple, Google and Microsoft's Mobile OS, Firefox OS, too, has its app stores with lots of quality checks and security controlled mechanisms. Mozilla is facing certain security and privacy issues to control HTML5-enabled apps (as HTML5 does have some security problems).

## Major factors in favour of using Firefox OS

**Cost.** Because it is open source, manufacturers should be able to reduce the cost of smartphones built on Firefox. Therefore Firefox OS-based smartphones should cost less than ₹ 5000 (approximately US\$ 99).

**HTML5.** Like Android, Firefox OS is based on the Linux kernel. It is similar to Chrome OS. Mozilla wanted to create an entire OS in the style of its Web browser. The advantage of this is that Firefox OS will provide native support for HTML5, which is revolutionising the way developers build programs for the Web.

This should result in faster and more stable functionality. Also, users will be able to experience the full version of Google Maps, which runs in HTML5.

**Open source.** Firefox OS has been



Fig. 6: The music player interface in Firefox OS

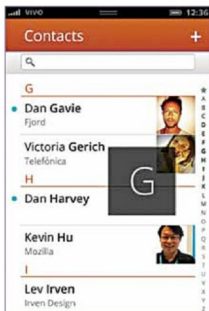


Fig. 7: The contact list in Firefox OS

built on top of Linux, which, as many developers are aware, is open source. This could be an advantage for manufacturers to modify Firefox OS according to their choice.

**Portability.** Firefox OS is expected to run well on all smartphone devices. In fact, sources close to Mozilla suggest the operating system will function well on any device powered by a 600MHz processor or better.

**Cloud storage.** One reason why Firefox OS-based devices need not